

Pet Skink Species Comparison Matrix

Species choice

- Blue-tongued skinks: visible terrestrial pets for prepared keepers with space, budget and locality-aware care.
- Red-eyed crocodile skink: observation species needing humid cover, quiet conditions and low handling.
- Fire skink: colorful burrowing species for keepers who accept hiding behavior and substrate depth.
- Emerald tree skink: active arboreal species needing height, branches, escape prevention and careful social planning.
- Sandfish skink: specialist fossorial species for desert-style burrowing setups and low handling expectations.

Decision rule

- Choose by adult enclosure, diet, humidity profile, visibility, handling expectation, legal/source status and long-term cost.
- Do not choose from appearance alone; a beautiful species can still be a poor match for the keeper and enclosure available.
- Do not use a single universal skink care number unless the source is truly about the exact species being kept.
- Treat temperature, humidity, substrate, lighting, diet and behavior as one husbandry system rather than isolated settings.
- Record observations in writing so changes in appetite, weight, shed quality and behavior are visible over time.

Best use

- Use this sheet before buying equipment, comparing species pages or discussing a purchase with a breeder, rescue or seller.

Use with the full Skinkpedia article. Exact values change by species, age, locality, enclosure design and health status. This resource is educational and does not replace species-specific husbandry research or reptile-veterinary advice.